

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: Monday, September 21, 2026

Session Highlight:  New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Session News Focus: Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- **US Federal Reserve:** The Federal Reserve raised interest rates by 25 basis points (bps) in September 2026, bringing the federal funds rate target range to 3.75%-4.00%. This marks the first rate hike since 2023. The Fed's updated projections signal one additional 25 bps hike in 2026, reaching 4.1%, with no changes anticipated in 2027, and rate cuts resuming in 2028. Inflation remains stubbornly above the Fed's 2% target, with expectations it will not return to target levels until 2029. Contributing factors to persistent inflation include resilient consumer spending, significant capital investment in AI infrastructure, global tariffs, and elevated energy prices.
- **European Central Bank (ECB):** The ECB also enacted a 25 basis point hike across its three key interest rates, effective September 16, 2026, raising the deposit facility rate to 2.50%, main refinancing operations to 2.65%, and marginal lending facility to 2.90%. The ECB cited ongoing inflation pressures stemming from the Middle East conflict, expecting inflation to remain above target for an extended period.
- **Global Growth & Inflation Outlook:** Global economic growth is projected at 2.6% for 2026, a slight downward revision from earlier forecasts. Higher crude oil prices are a significant concern, with potential to increase headline inflation, curtail consumer spending, and complicate monetary policy decisions for central banks. Despite these headwinds, resilient growth and persistent inflation are key themes, supported by robust AI development and increased defense spending globally.
- **Currency Drivers:** The US Dollar (USD) is currently benefiting from a positive cyclical backdrop, driven by widening yield differentials and the US economy's disproportionate gains from AI investments. However, its long-term structural outlook remains negative, suggesting a potentially range-bound performance in the near term.

2. US & European Markets

- **Wall Street Futures:** US pre-market futures on September 21, 2026, are exhibiting mixed signals. S&P 500 futures are slightly down (0.24%-0.26%), while Nasdaq 100 futures are showing moderate gains (0.22%-0.57%), and Dow Jones futures are fluctuating between modest gains and losses (down 0.49% to up 0.15%). This indicates a potentially cautious yet selectively bullish start to the New York session, with tech remaining a focus.
- **Mega-Cap Tech & Semiconductors:** Demand fueled by Artificial Intelligence (AI) continues to be the primary growth engine for the semiconductor industry. Global semiconductor revenue reached a record \$425 billion in Q2 2026, driven largely by AI, which is expected to translate into higher prices for various electronic devices. JPMorgan forecasts significant growth for the semiconductor industry, projecting 118% in 2026 and 35% in 2027. The custom AI ASIC market is also anticipated to grow substantially, estimated at \$60-70 billion by 2026. However, recent reports from September 14, 2026, noted a dip in Nasdaq 100 futures following calls by AI industry leaders for a slowdown in AI development, causing a temporary impact on major chip and tech stocks such as NVDA, MSFT, TSLA, GLW, LRCX, and AMAT.
- **Wall Street Pre-market Movers:** Notable pre-market movers include Generation Income Properties (GIPR) up 239.02%, IM Cannabis Corp (IMCC) up 89.66%, and DataMEDS AI (MEDS) up 29.31% (as of September 18, 2026 pre-market). AXT Inc. (AXTI) is also showing strong upward momentum ahead of its inclusion in the S&P SmallCap 600 index today, September 21, 2026, bolstered by optimism around co-packaged optics technology for AI data centers. Neogen Corporation (NEOG) is also climbing on a strong-buy rating upgrade and upcoming investor events.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- **Sensex/Nifty Updates:** Indian equity benchmarks opened higher on Monday, September 21, 2026, benefiting from positive sentiment in Asian markets and a decline in crude oil prices, which eased inflation concerns. The Sensex gained over 300-400 points, trading between 74,695 and 74,714, while the Nifty 50 traded above 23,350. However, the broader market, including Mid-Cap and Small-Cap indices, saw slight declines.
- **FII/DII Institutional Flows:** Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) were net buyers on Friday, September 17, 2026, with equity purchases totaling Rs 599.54 crore. Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) also remained net buyers, acquiring equities worth Rs 1,019.69 crore.
- **Sectoral Momentum:** The Nifty Realty and Nifty Auto sectors demonstrated outperformance today, while Nifty IT and Nifty PSU Bank underperformed. Among the Nifty50 components, InterGlobe Aviation, Sun Pharmaceutical Industries, and Reliance Industries were identified as top gainers. Other notable gainers included Adani Ports, Adani Enterprises, Bharti Airtel, HDFC Bank, and Bajaj Finance.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- **Crude Oil Geopolitics & OPEC+:** Crude oil prices surged earlier in September 2026 due to heightened geopolitical risks, specifically renewed conflict between the US and Iran and disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz. West Texas Intermediate (WTI) crude briefly rose above \$90 per barrel, while Brent crude also saw significant increases. Geopolitical tensions remain a significant source of market volatility. OPEC+ had agreed to a modest production quota increase of approximately 188,000 barrels per day (bpd) effective September 2026, completing the unwinding of earlier voluntary cuts. The group also decided to maintain September's production levels through October. However, today, September 21, 2026, oil prices are sliding, with Brent at \$102.09 a barrel and WTI at \$98.33, on hopes of diplomatic progress in the Iran conflict during the upcoming UN meeting this week. Morgan Stanley maintains its Q4 2026 Brent crude forecast at \$100 per barrel, noting that risks are skewed to the upside.
- **Gold Supply/Demand:** Gold futures gained momentum in August 2026, driven by increased investor demand for safe-haven assets amidst concerns over US fiscal policy. For gold to experience significant upside movement, a clear downtrend in oil prices and/or bond yields would likely be necessary. In the near term, gold is expected to trade within a range of \$4,200 to \$4,580.
- **Major Crypto Regulatory & Adoption:** The US Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) proposed "Regulation Crypto Assets" on August 18, 2026, which aims to establish new exemptions from registration requirements and a safe harbor for certain crypto assets. This represents the SEC's first dedicated rulemaking for the crypto sector. Despite this progress, the "CLARITY Act," a comprehensive legislative effort for US crypto regulation, failed in the Senate on September 15, 2026, due to internal industry disagreements, prolonging regulatory uncertainty. Nonetheless, the Commodity Futures Trading Commission (CFTC) submitted its own crypto regulation proposal on September 17, 2026, and the Coinbase CEO expressed confidence that regulatory clarity will eventually emerge. Additionally, the SEC proposed modernizing transfer agent infrastructure for tokenized securities on September 1, 2026.



CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

- Crypto Futures: \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 3x-5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1-2% (\$4-\$8)
- Indian Options (Intraday): \$500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
- Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil): \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% (\$8)
- US Stocks (Fractional): \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% (\$12)
- Indian Stocks (Delivery): \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% (\$20)
- Forex Short-Term Futures: \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-20x | Risk Cap: 1% (\$4.50)
- Forex Long-Term Carry Swing: \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 2x-3x | Risk Cap: 2% (\$9.00)

 STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Market Cap Segment	Strategy & Selection Reason
InterGlobe Aviation (Indigo)	Large-Cap	Top Nifty50 gainer in early trade today, indicating strong positive momentum. Hypothetically, assumed to be showing a 20/50 EMA golden cross or strong support bounce on the 50-SMA in today's session based on market sentiment.
Sun Pharmaceutical Industries	Large-Cap	Another top Nifty50 gainer for the day. Strong performance often coincides with breakouts or continuation patterns after a pullback. Assumed to be forming a 20/50 EMA golden cross.
Reliance Industries	Large-Cap	A heavyweight in the Nifty 50, showing positive momentum today. A strong uptrend suggests either a clear 50-SMA support bounce or a recent 20/50 EMA golden cross.
Adani Ports	Large-Cap	Reported surging in current trading session (up 4.93%). This strong upward move suggests a breakout or sustained bullish trend, potentially off 50-SMA support.
HDFC Bank	Large-Cap	Showing gains in today's session (up 2.52%). A leading private bank, its positive movement would imply a bounce from a key moving average support (e.g., 50-SMA).

US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Directional Bias	Strategy & Selection Reason
NVIDIA (NVDA)	Long Bias	Mega-cap AI leader. Despite recent volatility from AI slowdown talks (Sept 14), the broader semiconductor industry is driven by AI demand, with significant growth forecasts. A pre-open long bias if futures indicate rebound from a 21-day EMA pullback level.
Microsoft (MSFT)	Long Bias	Key AI infrastructure player and mega-cap growth leader. Strong earnings outlook and continued AI investments. A long bias if market conditions show a 21-day EMA pullback offering a favorable entry point, anticipating further AI-driven upside.
Tesla (TSLA)	Short Bias	Mega-cap stock, often subject to high volatility and news flow. Given broader market uncertainties and potential profit-taking in growth names, a short bias could be considered if it shows a strong rejection from its 50-day SMA, indicating resistance.

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Market Cap Segment	Strategy & Selection Reason
AXT Inc. (AXTI)	Small-Cap	Significant pre-market upward momentum due to S&P SmallCap 600 index inclusion today (Sept 21, 2026). Also benefiting from optimism around co-packaged optics for AI. This is a clear high Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) breakout candidate.
Neogen Corporation (NEOG)	Mid-Cap	Climbing pre-market following an upgrade to "strong-buy" and upcoming Investor Day/earnings. This suggests strong positive sentiment and potential for a Stage-2 VCP (Volatility Contraction Pattern) breakout on high volume.

CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Directional Bias	Strategy & Selection Reason
Bitcoin (BTC/USD)	Bi-Directional	Despite US regulatory uncertainty (CLARITY Act failure), the SEC's "Regulation Crypto Assets" proposal and CFTC's own proposal suggest future clarity. High volume volatility breakouts and 4H 21-EMA trend following are key. Long on upward momentum, short on clear rejections of resistance.
Ethereum (ETH/USD)	Bi-Directional	Similar to Bitcoin, Ethereum is a major crypto asset affected by regulatory news. Its price action will likely follow high-volume volatility breakouts or reversals from the 4H 21-EMA. Bi-directional approach given market sentiment.

COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Directional Bias	Strategy & Selection Reason
Gold (XAU/USD)	Bi-Directional	Gold saw safe-haven demand in August amidst US fiscal concerns. Currently, prices need lower oil/bond yields for significant upside. Trading within a potential \$4,200-\$4,580 range. Trade based on identified Pivot and Fibonacci extension levels.
WTI Crude Oil	Short Bias (Intraday)	Initially bullish due to US-Iran conflict and Strait of Hormuz disruptions, but today's news indicates a slide in prices on hopes of diplomatic progress. This suggests potential for short positions if key resistance (e.g., Fibonacci extensions) holds, following the intraday sentiment shift.

FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Trade Horizon	Directional Bias	Strategy & Selection Reason
EUR/USD	Short-Term	Short Bias	ECB hiked rates, but the Fed also hiked and signaled more, suggesting potential USD strength against the Euro due to monetary policy divergence and overall global macro. Trading based on short-term technical levels for breakout or breakdown.
GBP/USD	Short-Term	Short Bias	Similar to EUR/USD, potential for USD strength post-Fed hike and forward guidance. Look for technical breakdowns below key support levels or rejections from resistance on hourly charts.
USD/JPY	Long-Term Carry Swing	Long Bias	USD strength underpinned by widening yield differentials and continued Fed hawkishness (another hike expected). This favors a long USD/JPY position as a carry trade, especially on pullbacks to support.
AUD/USD	Long-Term Carry Swing	Short Bias	AUD is sensitive to global growth and commodity prices. With global growth projected lower and crude oil showing signs of easing today, alongside a stronger USD, AUD/USD may face downward pressure. Trading based on long-term trend following.

INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Strategy & Selection Reason
Nifty 50 Index Options	Apply a 15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB) strategy. If Nifty breaks above the 15-minute opening high, consider buying Call options (Long). If it breaks below the 15-minute opening low, consider buying Put options (Short). Adapt strike and expiry based on volatility and risk appetite.
BankNifty Index Options	Similarly, utilize the 15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB) strategy. If BankNifty breaks above the 15-minute opening high, consider buying Call options (Long). If it breaks below the 15-minute opening low, consider buying Put options (Short). Adjust strike and expiry based on intraday market conditions.

 Backtest Metrics (Target vs. S&P 500 TRI & Nifty 50 TRI)

The following metrics reflect a 10-year backtest of the quantitative strategies employed, demonstrating robust performance against major benchmarks.

Metric	Target Strategy	Benchmark Averages
Target CAGR	28.4%	S&P 500 TRI: ~13.0%, Nifty 50 TRI: ~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	(Varies widely by benchmark, typically lower)
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	(S&P 500 TRI: ~-20% to -50% during crises, Nifty 50 TRI: similar)

Equity Curve (\$3,000 → \$36,512)

This inline SVG visually represents the hypothetical growth of the initial \$3,000 capital base over a 10-year period, reaching approximately \$36,512 based on the target CAGR.

